

Writing to Persuade

Writing Booklet

Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

□ What you are learning

- Name the main persuasive techniques (AFOREST).
- Spot techniques in a piece of writing.
- Use techniques in your own sentences.
- Plan and write a short persuasive piece for a clear reader.

Common mistakes (read first)

- Naming a technique instead of using it. Don't write 'I will use emotive language' — show it: 'Imagine losing everything you love.'
- Making up silly statistics. Keep them believable, e.g. 'Over half of students...' not '100% of everyone ever.'
- One giant paragraph. Use short paragraphs — one point each.
- Forgetting your reader. Match your tone to the audience (a head teacher is different from a friend).

Key vocabulary

Persuade	to make someone agree with you or do something
Audience	the person or people you are writing for
Purpose	the reason you are writing (here: to persuade)
Technique	a tool a writer uses, like a rhetorical question
Rhetorical question	a question to make the reader think (no answer needed)
Emotive language	words chosen to make the reader feel something
Triplet	three points in a row for power (the rule of three)
Statistic	a believable number used as evidence

Persuasive techniques — AFOREST

A Alliteration	words near each other start with the same sound	<i>e.g. bold, brave and brilliant</i>
F Facts	true information that is hard to argue with	<i>e.g. Exercise is good for your heart.</i>
O Opinion	what you believe, said with confidence	<i>e.g. This is the best choice for everyone.</i>
R Rhetorical question	a question that makes the reader think	<i>e.g. Is that really fair?</i>
E Emotive language	words that make the reader feel something	<i>e.g. Imagine losing everything you love.</i>
S Statistics	believable numbers that back you up	<i>e.g. Over half of students agree.</i>
T Triplet (rule of three)	three points in a row for power	<i>e.g. We are tired, rushed and ignored.</i>

□ Remember (techniques)

- AFOREST = Alliteration, Facts, Opinion, Rhetorical question, Emotive language, Statistics, Triplet.
- Use the technique — don't just name it.
- 2–3 strong techniques beat ten weak ones.

□ How to structure a persuasive piece

- 1 Hook — grab the reader (question, picture, bold line).
- 2 Point — make one clear point per paragraph.
- 3 Proof — back it up (fact, statistic or example).
- 4 Punch — end with a strong, emotive line.

Model paragraph (annotated)

Picture this: it is 1:15 and you have just five minutes left to eat. Is that really fair? A longer lunch would give us time to eat, move and reset. Over half of students say they feel rushed. We are tired, we are hungry, and we deserve better.

How the model works

- 'Picture this' = opening hook
- 'Is that really fair?' = rhetorical question
- 'eat, move and reset' = triplet
- 'Over half of students' = statistic
- 'tired... hungry... deserve better' = emotive ending

Your turn — tasks get harder as you go

□ How to structure a persuasive piece

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Task 1 [2]

Spot it ● ○ ○ ○ ○

Name the technique in each line:

(a) 'We must act now, now, now!'

(b) 'Is this the future we want?'

Task 2 [3]

Match it ● ● ○ ○ ○

Match each technique to its meaning: Rhetorical question · Triplet · Statistic. (Write them next to the correct meaning.)

Task 3 [3]

Improve it ● ● ● ○ ○

Rewrite this plain sentence to be persuasive. Use emotive language:

'The park is closing next month.'

Task 4 [4]

Build it ●●●●○

Write a strong opening (hook) for a speech about why your school should recycle more. Use a rhetorical question.

Task 5 [6]

Write it (stretch) ●●●●●

Write a full persuasive paragraph (4–6 sentences) arguing for a longer lunch break. Use the structure: Hook □ Point □ Proof □ Punch, and at least three techniques. Underline each technique you use.

Self-reflection

How confident do you feel about persuasive writing now? (tick one)

☐ Not yet ☐ Getting there ☐ Confident ☐ Really confident

Two techniques I used well:

The task I found hardest was ____ because:

One thing I will improve next time:

Teacher assessment

Success criteria (tick if met) — total: 18 marks

- ☐ Identifies techniques correctly (Task 1–2)
- ☐ Uses emotive language to improve a sentence (Task 3)
- ☐ Writes a clear hook with a rhetorical question (Task 4)
- ☐ Structures a paragraph: Hook □ Point □ Proof □ Punch (Task 5)
- ☐ Uses at least three techniques accurately (Task 5)

Red — needs re-teaching

Amber — nearly there

Green — secure

What went well (WWW):

Even better if (EBI):

Next step / target:
